



Is the proposal real? A scope-of-work checklist

Use this to judge whether a web or content agency's GEO proposal is substance or vapour. Work through the checklist against their scope of work, and use the questions to probe anything that is vague.

PREPARED FOR [DESTINATION] · WITH THE DIGITAL TOURISM THINK TANK

A confident proposal is not the same as a real one. Work through the agency's scope of work against the checklist below. A strong proposal can answer almost all of it without you asking. Where it cannot, use the probing questions before you commit.

01 Scope and deliverables

- ☐ Named, specific deliverables, not just an approach.
- ☐ The priority pages are identified, or a method to identify them is.
- ☐ A timeline with milestones, and a named owner on their side.
- ☐ What is in scope and what is explicitly out of scope.

02 Content and technical

- ☐ A clear answer-first method for rewrites, and who writes them.
- ☐ An acceptance test for a finished page.
- ☐ Schema matched to visible content, and validated with a named tool.
- ☐ AI crawler access checked, and mobile and page speed addressed.

03 Entity, authority and measurement

- ☐ A plan for consistent facts across your site and third party profiles.
- ☐ Reviews and listings addressed, honestly and within the rules.
- ☐ A defined priority question set, and how appearance will be tracked.
- ☐ A reporting cadence you can actually act on.

04 Commercial and ethics

- ☐ You own the content, schema and data created.
- ☐ A clean exit, with export of everything in a usable format.
- ☐ Maintenance and handover, so you are not locked in.
- ☐ Costs are transparent, including setup, overages and ongoing fees.
- ☐ No hidden text, no fabricated reviews, no schema that misrepresents the page.

HOW TO READ THE RESULT

If the commercial and ethics section has any gap, resolve it before signing, not after. A weak answer there outweighs a strong answer everywhere else. The earlier sections shape the quality of the work. This last one decides whether the work is safe to buy.

05 Probing questions for anything vague

- Can you show this working on another client, with the result.
- What exactly will I have at the end, and can I maintain it without you.
- Walk me through how you validate schema and keep it matched to the page.
- What happens to my content and data if we part ways.
- Which tactics will you not use here, and why.

Prepared with the Digital Tourism Think Tank as part of the [destination] AI Discoverability programme. Adapt the bracketed fields before use.